Data report

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Raw counts, matched counts and attrition, reported separately. The 200,000 figure in the proposal was a post-merge count; the sample is 117,926 events.

1. Raw counts

`funnel_counts.py`, `build_event_table.py`.

Every 8-K carrying Item 2.02, 2006 through 2025, from the SEC EDGAR bulk submissions archive. Item codes are not in `form.idx`, so the `items` field of each filer's submissions record is the only complete source. The raw universe is **383,153 filings** out of 1,549,567 8-Ks, from 4,277 to 6,003 distinct filers a year.

Year	Item 2.02	All 8-K	Filers	Year	Item 2.02	All 8-K	Filers
2006	23,378	106,308	6,003	2016	18,439	72,621	4,704
2007	22,769	101,306	5,964	2017	17,983	70,786	4,581
2008	22,210	90,923	5,593	2018	17,726	68,182	4,511
2009	20,490	81,965	5,244	2019	17,321	66,428	4,409
2010	19,596	80,443	5,127	2020	17,874	72,331	4,397
2011	19,068	78,825	4,983	2021	18,585	74,563	4,731
2012	18,811	77,353	4,844	2022	19,045	69,685	4,707
2013	18,484	76,369	4,839	2023	18,518	72,028	4,577
2014	18,900	76,930	4,904	2024	17,771	68,462	4,399
2015	19,021	76,408	4,917	2025	17,164	67,651	4,277

The count falls by about a quarter over the period, in line with the fall in the number of listed firms.

2. Match attrition

`wrds_match_and_funnel.py`.

Each line is an exact count of the rows surviving that stage, not a difference of separately computed totals.

Stage	Remaining	Removed	Removed %
8-K Item 2.02 filings, 2006 to 2025	383,153		
Matched to a PERMNO, link window respected	328,317	54,836	14.3
Release session is a CRSP trading day	322,448	5,869	1.8
A CRSP price exists at $t-2$	283,279	39,169	12.2
Price at $t-2$ above \$5	228,417	54,862	19.4
Market cap above the NYSE 20th percentile	148,912	79,505	34.8
At least three analysts in the prior 90 days	117,926	30,986	20.8

The size cut removes more than any other stage, 79,505 events. It is a choice: a signal that works only in micro caps answers a different question. Analyst coverage removes a further 30,986 and is unavoidable, since a surprise needs a consensus to be a surprise against. What survives is a liquid, well-covered universe, median market capitalisation \$3.4bn and median nine analysts.

The 14.3% that fails to match a PERMNO is mostly filers with no CRSP-listed common equity. We use `crsp.dsf_v2` rather than `crsp.dsf`: the legacy file ends 2024-12-31 and drops all 15,988 events of 2025.

3. Release text

`fetch_releases.py`.

Recovered for **116,983 of 117,926 events, 99.2%**. It is not always in EX-99.1.

Source document	Events	Share
EX-99.1 and its variants	103,852	88.1%
Other EX-99 exhibits	11,269	9.6%
The 8-K body itself	1,862	1.6%
No prose document found	941	0.8%
Index page unreachable	2	0.0%

Taking EX-99.1 alone would lose 11.2%. We read each filing's index page for the document types, fetch exhibits in order of preference, and accept the first that reads as prose: at least 500 words, ten or more sentence breaks, under 25% digits.

Financial-statement tables are dropped and layout tables kept, decided per table on its digit ratio. Removing every table destroys whole releases from the earlier years, which wrap the entire document in a layout table. Median release 3,157 words, 1,437 at the tenth percentile, 5,960 at the ninetieth, three tables dropped.

4. Release timing

`validate_timing.py`, `wire_times.py`, `three_source_timing.py`.

No single field gives first dissemination. We use three sources and report their disagreement.

EDGAR. The submissions JSON is true UTC and the filing header is Eastern; both are converted to New York time. Acceptance at or after 16:00 belongs to the next session, before 09:30 to the same one. Where the `filingDate` is later than the acceptance date we take 06:00 ET on the `filingDate`.

I/B/E/S. ANNDATS and ANNTIMS, never ACTDATS or ACTTIMS, with 00:00:00 treated as missing rather than midnight. Each announcement is paired with the nearest EDGAR event within three calendar days; a wider window starts pairing adjacent quarters and manufactures agreement.

An I/B/E/S announcement exists for 106,418 events, 90.2%, and nearly all carry a usable time. The two sources agree on the session for **88,448 events, 83.1% of those matched**. Requiring two agreeing sources would leave 75.0% of the sample and drop 29,478: 11,508 with no I/B/E/S match and 17,970 matched to a different session.

Those 17,970 are two different problems.

Kind of disagreement	Events
Same announcement date, I/B/E/S after the close, EDGAR in session	12,809
Same announcement date, I/B/E/S after the close, EDGAR pre-open	154
Same announcement date, both after the close, different session	27
EDGAR session one to three days after the I/B/E/S date	4,706
EDGAR session before the I/B/E/S date	274

For 12,990 of them the two sources agree on the day and differ on the side of the close, which moves the start of the return window by one session. The 4,706 where EDGAR trails by up to three days are acceptance lag, and there EDGAR is wrong about when the information became public.

Dow Jones wire. We expected to need Bloomberg or Factiva. RavenPack's Dow Jones press-release file turns out to be inside our entitlement, one table per year back to 2000, with a UTC timestamp on every story. We take the earliest press-release story per firm and day at relevance 100 in an earnings category, convert to New York time, and map the entity to PERMNO through CUSIP with validity windows on both sides. That gives 444,915 firm-days across 8,853 securities and a wire time for 90,437 of our events, 76.7%.

Pair, among events where both sources exist	Same session	Share
I/B/E/S with the Dow Jones wire	86,374 of 87,647	98.5%
EDGAR with the Dow Jones wire	75,775 of 90,437	83.8%
EDGAR with I/B/E/S	88,448 of 106,418	83.1%

The two sources that record when the firm announced agree almost perfectly. EDGAR disagrees with both at about the same rate, so EDGAR acceptance is the outlier. Requiring at least two agreeing sources retains 104,259 events, 88.4%, and drops 13,667: 8,718 with no second source and 4,949 with one that disagrees.

Taking the wire where it exists moves 14,662 events, 12.4%, to a different session. For **10,526 of them EDGAR places the release one to three sessions too early**, because the firm filed the 8-K during the session and put the release on the wire after the close. Keying the return window on EDGAR there opens it before the information was public, a look-ahead on roughly 9% of the sample. For 4,136 events EDGAR is one to three sessions too late, which costs us the reaction rather than contaminating it.

We therefore key the return windows on the wire time where it exists and on EDGAR where it does not, and carry the source as a column so any result can be re-run on the agreeing subset alone.

5. Access, confirmed by query

Each line was confirmed by selecting from the table rather than from the catalogue, because an entitlement that renders in a form can still refuse a query.

Source	Status	What the query returned
`crsp.dsf_v2`	available	coverage to 2025-12-31
`crsp.dsf` (legacy)	available	coverage to 2024-12-31, so not used
`ibes.det_guidance`	available	331,963 rows since 2024-01-01, 23 columns including `anndats`, `anntims`, `guidance_code`, `val_1`, `val_2`, `mean_at_date`
`ibes.actu_epsus`, `detu_epsus`	available	unadjusted actuals and detail, to 2026-08-20
`wrdsapps.ibcrsphist`	available	37,662 link rows, used at score ≤ 3
`crsp.ccmxpf_lnkhist`	available	123,388 link rows
`wrdssec.wciklink_gvkey`	available	1,089,092 rows
`ravenpack_dj`	available	55 tables, Dow Jones press releases by year
FactSet Estimates	available	access runs through Sloan Technology Services